

Naija Empires — Civilizations, Perks & Bonuses

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How civilizations work

Each civilization (an empire/"state") plays differently through three levers:

- 1. **Unique unit** — a signature troop only that civ can train.
- 2. **Passive bonuses** — always-on perks (economy, military, or defence) that shape its playstyle.
- 3. **Wonder** — a landmark that can be built for prestige and an alternate win path.

Civs are designed to be **distinct but balanced** — every civ has a clear strength and a matching weakness, so the rock-paper-scissors of unit counters (Spear ► Cavalry ► Archer ► Spear) still decides fights.

MVP status: **Benin** and **Oyo** are the two playable civs in the current build; the other four are designed here for the post-MVP roadmap. Benin's defensive bonuses are already live in code (`Config/GameConfig.cs`); the rest are the design spec to implement next.

At a glance

Civilization	Playstyle	Unique Unit	Signature Bonus	Status
Benin Empire	Defensive fortress	Iyokuo Royal Guard	Walls & Towers –30% cost, +50% HP	✓ Playable
Oyo Empire	Cavalry aggression	Eso Cavalry	Cavalry faster, cheaper, quicker	✓ Playable
Sokoto Caliphate	Fast-teching economy	Sokoto Lancer	Advance Ages faster & cheaper	🚧 Designed
Kanem-Bornu	Trade & ranged	Camel Archer	Markets earn extra Cowries; +range	🚧 Designed
Hausa City-States	Walled commerce	Kano Archer	Cheaper economy; strong behind walls	🚧 Designed
Nri Kingdom	Support & economy	Nri Priest	Villagers work faster; healing	🚧 Designed

1. Benin Empire — *The Fortress* ✓ Playable

Playstyle: Defensive turtle. Hold strong behind unbreakable walls, out-tech the enemy, and win the late game.

Unique unit — Iyokuo Royal Guard: Elite heavy infantry. Tanky, strong against cavalry, the backbone of a Benin hold.

Bonuses - Walls & Towers cost –30% (live) - Towers have +50% HP (live) - Town Centre +25% HP — your heart is harder to crack. - **Bronze-working:** military upgrades cost –20% (the famed Benin bronze guild).

Wonder: *The Walls of Benin* — one of history's largest earthworks.

Strength / Weakness: Nearly unbreakable on defence and strong late · slower, weaker early aggression.

History: The Benin Kingdom built vast city walls and moats (and the related Sungbo's Eredo) and was renowned for its bronze-casting guild — hence a defensive, craft-strong identity.

2. Oyo Empire — *The Cavalry* Playable

Playstyle: Fast and aggressive. Pressure early with cavalry, raid the enemy economy, never let them settle.

Unique unit — Eso Cavalry: Fast, hard-hitting mounted shock troops — Oyo's historic strike force.

Bonuses - Cavalry train 33% faster. - Cavalry cost –15%. - Cavalry move +10% speed — better raids and escapes. - **Stables cost –20%.**

Wonder: *The Aafin (Royal Palace of Oyo)*.

Strength / Weakness: Dominant early/mid aggression and map control · weaker walls and a soft late game vs spearmen-heavy defences.

History: The Oyo Empire's power rested on its formidable cavalry (the Eso warriors), dominating the savannah where horses thrived.

3. Sokoto Caliphate — *The Scholars* Designed

Playstyle: Boom and tech. Reach higher Ages first and overwhelm with a more advanced army and economy.

Unique unit — Sokoto Lancer: Mounted lancer that excels against archers and raiders.

Bonuses - Advance Ages 25% faster. - Age-up costs –20%. - Trade/Market income +15%. - Villagers gather Yam +10%.

Wonder: *The Great Mosque* — a beacon of scholarship.

Strength / Weakness: Fastest to a tech/economy lead · vulnerable to early all-in rushes before the boom pays off.

History: The 19th-century Sokoto Caliphate was a vast, organised state famed for scholarship, administration, and trans-regional trade.

4. Kanem-Bornu — *The Traders* Designed

Playstyle: Trade-fuelled ranged army. Build wealth through markets and win at range with camels and archers.

Unique unit — Camel Archer: Mobile ranged unit that resists enemy cavalry (camels unsettle horses).

Bonuses - Markets generate passive Cowries (trade currency). - **Trade income +20%. - Archers +1 range. - Camel units take –25% bonus damage from cavalry.**

Wonder: *The Trans-Saharan Caravanseraï.*

Strength / Weakness: Rich economy and superior ranged poke · weaker in close melee brawls.

History: The Kanem-Bornu Empire around Lake Chad thrived for centuries on trans-Saharan trade and fielded camel cavalry and early firearms.

5. Hausa City-States — *The Walled Merchants* 🚧 Designed

Playstyle: Walled economic powerhouse. Out-produce everyone from behind great city walls.

Unique unit — Kano Archer: Defensive archer that gains extra power when fighting near friendly walls/towers.

Bonuses - Economy buildings cost -15%. - Start with +1 extra Villager. - Walls & gates cost -25%. - Trade income +15%.

Wonder: *The Great Walls of Kano.*

Strength / Weakness: Strongest sustained economy behind walls · must defend well; weaker open-field aggression.

History: The Hausa city-states (Kano, Katsina, Zaria...) were walled commercial hubs famous for dyeing, crafts, and long-distance trade.

6. Nri Kingdom — *The Priest-Kings* 🚧 Designed

Playstyle: Support and economy. A peaceful, fast-growing economy backed by healers rather than raw aggression.

Unique unit — Nri Priest: Heals nearby friendly units and can convert enemies — a force multiplier, not a frontline fighter.

Bonuses - Villagers work +15% faster. - Houses provide +1 extra population each. - Units slowly regenerate health near a Town Centre. - Priests heal allies in an area.

Wonder: *The Sacred Grove of Nri.*

Strength / Weakness: Best economy-per-villager and great army sustain through healing · no innate military bonus — must out-play in fights.

History: The Nri Kingdom was an Igbo theocratic state led by priest-kings whose authority was spiritual rather than military — reflected here as a support/economy civ.

Balance philosophy

- **Every civ has a clear weakness.** Bonuses tilt a playstyle; they never make a civ strictly better.
- **Counters still rule fights.** Civ perks change *economy, tempo, and durability* — the Spear/Cavalry/Archer triangle still decides battles, so no civ is unbeatable.
- **Numbers are tunable.** All values live in `Config/GameConfig.cs` and will be adjusted from playtests.

Implementation roadmap

Phase	Civs
Now (M1)	Benin (defensive bonuses live), Oyo
Next	Sokoto, Kanem-Bornu (economy/tech + trade systems)
Later	Hausa City-States, Nri (walls + support/healing systems)

All civilizations, units, bonuses, and numbers are a design starting point, open to iteration from playtesting.